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**Do women really want power to challenge people and channel their potential?
Can they make and manage money? Ten talented women show the way.**

Women and money are not natural allies. They are often seen as its consumers, rather than its makers, its destination rather than its origin. But increasingly in urban India, women are important not only because they are a significant reason why the apparel market is growing at a rate of 18 per cent a year, or a fair explanation for why the \$318 million market for skin care has grown by over 42 per cent since 2001. Often, they are the decision makers behind such growth, the leaders who power risk-taking companies, who manage investments, and in some cases analyse its patterns. These are women who have not only busted myths like the opt-out revolution but also proved that a corner office in corporate India does not come at the cost of a postcard perfect family and that the accoutrements of success are not restricted to the men who make it. So here is INDIA TODAY's list of powerful money managers, who range from the woman who heads one of the country's oldest banks to another who manages its most innovative micro-finance transformation, from an entrepreneur who saw the future of outsourcing to a bureaucrat who refuses to govern change from inside air-conditioned confines. As these women show, making money isn't only about fulfilling individual aspirations, it is about providing collective inspiration as well.